IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation

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Inviting Proposals for Innovation and Startup Support under IBITF Schemes

Call for Proposal
For various operational Schemes under IBITF

IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF)

Category 'A' - Technology Innovation Hub (TIH) under the National Mission of Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS), Executed by The Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India (GoI)

Introduction

The **IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF)** is a Section-8 not-for-profit company, established under the National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS) of the Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India. IBITF focuses on the development and deployment of projects in the Fintech domain, focusing on identifying impactful solutions leveraging emerging technologies like Blockchain, IoT, AI/ML, and e-payments, with a primary emphasis on applying these technologies to other sectors like Agriculture and HealthTech.

IBITF has been recognised as a Category-A Hub based on its performance and outcomes since its inception. IBITF provides a vibrant ecosystem that connects startups, researchers, academia, industry, and government stakeholders. Through funding support, incubation facilities, expert mentorship, and market access, IBITF empowers innovators to transform ideas into scalable, impactful solutions that address real-world challenges and contribute to India's growth as a global innovation leader. The Foundation plays a pivotal role in translating deep-tech research into market-ready products and solutions, and in nurturing startups, particularly from Tier II/III cities and rural areas.

About the Call for Proposals

The IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF) invites proposals from startups, entrepreneurs, technology innovators and industry, working on innovative and technology-driven solutions in the areas of FinTech, AgriTech, HealthTech, and other emerging technologies aligned with IBITF's mandate.

Through this Call for Proposals, IBITF aims to identify and support high-potential startups and innovative solutions that have the potential to address real-world challenges, strengthen existing technologies, and achieve product development, deployment, and commercialization. Selected proposals will be provided appropriate support through funding assistance, technical and domain mentorship, industry connect, incubation support, and opportunities for market and ecosystem linkages, subject to the applicable scheme provisions and availability of funds.

IBITF particularly encourages startups and innovators with market-ready or near-market technologies, scalable business models, strong technical capabilities, and potential for meaningful social and economic impact to participate in the Call.

Selected startups may be provided access to office space at IT Park, Durg, subject to availability and applicable terms, to facilitate engagement with IBITF and access to mentorship, networking, industry interaction, and the wider innovation ecosystem. and providing opportunities for collaboration, mentorship, networking, industry interaction, and access to the wider innovation ecosystem.

The Call aims to build a strong pipeline of innovative startups and technology solutions and facilitate their journey from innovation to product development, deployment, and commercialization.

Project Categories and Eligibility

The various Scheme supports proposals under the following categories:

Startups/Industry Submitting a New Idea to IBITF

- **Eligibility:** DPIIT-recognized startups, Registered companies (MSMEs or Enterprises) with prior product development or R&D experience.
- **Expected Deliverables:**
    - Prototype/MVP within 6 - 8 months
    - Go-to-market readiness and business plan within 12 months
    - Revenue Generation
- **IP and Revenue Sharing:**
    - Governed through a mutually agreed-upon agreement between the Startup and IBITF, based on IP contributions, investment, and commercialization.

Evaluation Criteria (All Categories)

The evaluation of proposals submitted will be based on a comprehensive review of key parameters aligned with IBITF's strategic objectives. Proposals must demonstrate strong technical innovation and novelty, showcasing the ability to address critical challenges through transformative solutions. Particular emphasis will be placed on market fit and commercial viability, ensuring that the proposed solution has a well-defined target audience, value proposition, and a feasible go-to-market strategy.

The strength of the project team including the experience and technical expertise of the Founder,Co-Founder, startup, industry, and collaborating partners—will also play a critical role in

the assessment process. In addition, IBITF places importance on the intellectual property (IP) potential of the proposal and its alignment with the required Technology Readiness Level (TRL), which should ideally be TRL-3 or higher for proposals closer to deployment.

Budget justification, including a realistic cost estimate and clarity on the proposed co-funding mechanism, will be scrutinized to ensure optimal utilization of resources and alignment with project goals. Post the internal evaluation, which will check whether the proposal is aligned with IBITF's mandated technology domains, IBITF will constitute a Project Review Committee, which will follow a three-stage evaluation process.

- **Stage-01** Technical evaluation of the proposed solution.
- **Stage-02** Business and commercial viability of the project.
- **Stage-03** Financial and legal evaluation of the participating organizations/entities.

It should be noted that the relative emphasis on these parameters may vary depending on the nature of the proposal. The parameters that will support the approval of a project proposal by the IBITF project review committee may include (but are not limited to) technical feasibility, market viability, proposed co-funding mechanism, team strength, IP potential, and the strength of research credentials.

Project Duration

All proposals should have an initial duration of **6 to 12 months**. Meeting milestones and Key Performance Indicators may provide leverage for future funding, when a new cohort call is made.

Funding and Disbursement

1. Any proposal submitted should include at least **40%** contribution to the project cost from the proposing entity (DPIIT-recognized startups, Registered companies (MSMEs or Enterprises), etc, with prior product development or R&D experience).
2. The extent of financial support from IBITF shall be contingent upon factors such as the availability of funds from the funding agency, the technical feasibility and novelty of the proposal, its commercial viability, alignment with industry/government requirements, and engagement from other stakeholders associated with the proposal.
3. Proposing entities that can mobilize investments from investors, private funds, etc (other than government grants/FDI's and schemes) shall be considered eligible for funding support from IBITF.

The fund disbursement and project execution framework shall be communicated to the proposing entities upon successful completion of Stage 1 of the evaluation process, i.e., post-technical evaluation and recommendation by the committee for subsequent evaluation stages.

The framework will provide an overview of the fund disbursement process, financial management norms, and the project execution structure, along with the roles and responsibilities of the collaborating partners.

Revenue Sharing Structure (Indicative)

The revenue-sharing framework for projects funded under this Call for Proposal will be formalized between IBITF and the collaborating partner(s) through a mutually agreed agreement, executed on a case-by-case basis. The terms and conditions specified in the agreement shall govern the arrangement.

Revenue-sharing agreements will remain valid for a period of **ten (10) consecutive years,** commencing from the financial year as determined by IBITF and communicated prior to its commencement.

The following table presents an indicative revenue-sharing structure for consideration during post-selection discussions.

Sl. No.	Annual Company Revenue	Option 1: IBITF Share (%)	Option 2: IBITF Share (%)
1	Up to ₹10 lakh	0.50%	2.00%
2	Above ₹10 lakh and up to ₹50 lakh	1.00%	1.50%
3	Above ₹50 lakh and up to ₹100 lakh	1.50%	1.00%
4	Above ₹100 lakh	2.00%	0.50%

The applicable option, revenue calculation methodology, commencement date, duration, reporting requirements, and other relevant terms shall be finalised through mutual discussion and incorporated into the collaboration agreement.

Note: The above structure is indicative and shall not constitute a binding financial commitment at the proposal submission stage. The final revenue-sharing arrangement shall be subject to approval by IBITF and execution of the collaboration agreement.

Application Process

Deadline for Proposal Submission: 26th November 2026.

All proposals must be submitted via the **Accubate Platform Link** (given below).

**Please note that all annexures provided below should be attached to the submitted proposal.*

A copy of the submitted applications shall be emailed to tih@iitbhilai.ac.in

Link for Accubate Platform to apply:- https://tihiitbhilai.accubate.app/ext/form/24560/1/apply

Contact

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Proposal Submission Format

IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF)
A Technology Innovation Hub under NM-ICPS, DST, Government of India

1. Title of the Proposal

2. Thematic Area

Select the core area under which your project lies:
☐ AI/ML
☐ Blockchain
☐ IoT
☐ E-Payments System
☐ Agritech
☐ Healthtech
☐ Others (Please specify): _____

3. Proposed Duration of the Project

☐ 6 Months
☐ 9 Months
☐ 12 Months
(Extendable based on performance)

4. Aims, Objectives, and Problem Statement (Max. 500 words)

- Background and rationale
- Targeted beneficiaries
- Specific problems to be addressed and expected outcomes

5. Startup / Industry Partner Details

Name of Company:
Type: ☐ DPIIT Registered Startup ☐ MSME/SME ☐ Large Enterprise ☐ Any other (please specify)
Company Incorporation Date
CIN
TAN
PAN

Company Age …. Month ….Years
Founder(s) / CEO/Head of organization:
Address:
Email:
Phone:
Website (if any):
DPIIT Recognition Number (for startups):

6. Business Plan and Co-Funding Details

- Summary of business goals and partnership structure
- Funding contribution by startup/industry partner (in % and absolute terms)

7. Novelty and Innovation (Max. 250 words)

- How is the proposed solution distinct from current methods?
- What innovative elements or IP does it involve?

8. Revenue and Commercialization Model (Max. 500 words)

- Product/Service description
- Go-to-market strategy
- Pricing, revenue generation, and scalability plan

9. Project Plan and TRL Progression

- Attach a quarterly Gantt Chart with deliverables
- Indicate TRL at the start and expected TRL after each quarter
- Expected TRL at project end (minimum TRL-3)

10. Patents, Publications, and Prototypes Developed (if any)

List all relevant IPs, published work, and prototypes. Mention status (granted/filed/under dev).

11. Deliverables

Please include estimates for:

- Projected Revenue and Expenditure Plan
- Expected Publications / Technologies / IPRs
- Jobs to be created and future hiring roadmap

12. Gantt Chart with Quarterly Milestones and TRL Progression

13. Budget Estimate and Contribution Summary (in ₹ Lakhs)

Head	6 month	12 months	Industry/Startup Contribution	IBITF Support Requested
Equipment				
Travel				
Manpower				
Contingencies				
Total				

Note: All budget estimates should include justification.

14. Expertise and Infrastructure

- Brief profile of PI and Co-PIs
- Co-Funding Details:
  - Partner Name:
  - Contribution Amount:
  - Form (cash):
  - Timeline of Contribution:
- Facilities available with the host institute/startup/industry for execution

Applicants shall submit all applicable annexures and supporting documents specified in the CFP along with their proposals. Annexure B is provided for information regarding the indicative post-selection collaboration and funding framework. The formal collaboration agreement shall be finalised and executed with selected applicants after the evaluation, negotiation, and approval process, as applicable.

ANNEXURES

Annexure A

Startup/Industry Profile

Applicable for all categories

- Name of Entity:
- Year of Incorporation:
- Type of Entity and Last Year Turnover : (Startup/MSME/SME/Large - Turnover in Lac)
- DPIIT Recognition Number (if applicable):
- Date of Recognition under DPII:
- Registered Address:
- Website (if any):
- Founders/Directors/Co-founders Names & Designations:
- Contact Number:
- Email ID:
- Brief Overview of Product/Technology Developed (max 250 words):
- Attach Certificate of Incorporation and DPIIT Certificate (if applicable):

Annexure B

Letter of Collaboration / MoU / Partner Commitment

Applicable for All Categories

Post-Selection Collaboration and Funding Framework

Applicable to selected applicants, subject to the terms and conditions of the Call for Proposals

This annexure provides an indicative overview of the process and key terms applicable after the selection of a proposal under the Call for Proposals issued by IIT Bhilai Innovation and Technology Foundation (IBITF). It is intended to familiarise applicants with the subsequent stages of project approval, funding finalisation, and collaboration.

1. Post-Selection Process

Following the evaluation and recommendation of the designated committee, shortlisted applicants may be invited for further discussions with IBITF to finalise the project scope, implementation plan, funding requirements, applicant contribution, milestones, deliverables, and expected outcomes.

2. Indicative Funding Structure

The final funding structure shall be determined based on the approved project budget, applicant contribution, evaluation outcome, applicable scheme provisions, and availability of funds.

The following table illustrates the key components that may be considered during funding discussions.

Sl. No.	Funding Component	Details
1	Total Estimated Project Cost	As proposed and approved for the project
2	Applicant / Startup Contribution	Minimum 40% of the total project cost, as specified in the CFP
3	IBITF Support Requested	As proposed by the applicant and approved by IBITF

4	Mentorship / Incubation Support	As applicable under the approved support structure
5	Equity / iSAFE Component	Where applicable, subject to mutually agreed terms
6	Total Project Funding	As finalised and approved by IBITF

The applicant shall provide a detailed and justified budget, clearly indicating the proposed contribution, funding requirement, expenditure heads, and fund-utilisation plan. The final amount and mode of financial support shall be communicated to the selected applicant after the necessary evaluation and approval process.

3. Funding Negotiation and Finalisation

Selected applicants may be required to participate in a funding negotiation round to discuss the proposed budget, contribution structure, project milestones, implementation schedule, deliverables, and commercialisation plan.

IBITF may seek revisions to the proposal, budget, or implementation plan before final approval. The final funding structure and disbursement schedule shall be documented in the collaboration agreement and shall remain subject to the availability and approval of funds.

4. Revenue Sharing and Commercialisation

Where applicable, revenue-sharing arrangements shall be finalised between IBITF and the selected applicant based on the approved funding structure, investment contribution, and commercialisation plan.

The indicative revenue-sharing table provided in the CFP may be used as a basis for discussion. The applicable option, revenue calculation methodology, duration, and other commercial terms shall be mutually agreed upon and documented in the final collaboration agreement.

5. Financial Governance and Fund Disbursement

The selected applicant shall comply with the approved financial management and fund-utilisation requirements. Fund disbursement may be linked to agreed milestones, deliverables, progress reviews, and submission of the required technical and financial reports.

The applicant shall maintain appropriate records of expenditure and ensure that funds are utilised exclusively for approved project activities. A dedicated or joint bank account, transaction authorisation mechanism, and other financial governance requirements shall apply where specified in the approved funding arrangement and final collaboration agreement.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

The roles and responsibilities of IBITF and the selected applicant shall be defined in the collaboration agreement. These may include project implementation, technical development, mentorship, monitoring, reporting, financial compliance, commercialisation, and achievement of agreed project outcomes.

Where an academic or industry partner is involved, its role and responsibilities shall also be documented, as applicable.

7. Intellectual Property and Commercialisation Rights

The ownership, licensing, use, and commercialisation of existing intellectual property and intellectual property developed during the project shall be governed by the terms mutually agreed upon and documented in the collaboration agreement.

Applicants shall disclose relevant existing intellectual property, prototypes, technologies, and third-party rights associated with the proposed project.

8. Monitoring, Review and Project Closure

The progress of selected projects may be reviewed periodically against the approved milestones, deliverables, timelines, and expected outcomes. Applicants shall submit progress reports, technical presentations, utilisation details, and other documents as required by IBITF.

At the completion of the project, the applicant shall submit the final technical and financial reports and complete the applicable project closure and settlement requirements.

9. Execution of Collaboration Agreement

Before commencement of the funded project and disbursement of funds, as applicable, the selected applicant shall execute a formal collaboration agreement with IBITF. The agreement shall specify the final funding terms, applicant contribution, disbursement conditions, roles and responsibilities, financial governance, intellectual property rights, confidentiality, revenue-sharing arrangements, termination provisions, and other applicable legal and financial obligations.

Important Note

This annexure is indicative and is intended to inform applicants about the post-selection process. Submission of a proposal or selection at any evaluation stage shall not, by itself, constitute a commitment of funding by IBITF. Final selection, funding approval, disbursement, and collaboration shall be subject to the applicable evaluation process, approval of the competent authority, availability of funds, and execution of the required collaboration agreement.

Annexure C

Certificate and Endorsement

Applicable for All Categories

D1: Certificate from Startup/Industry (on official letterhead)

I/We certify that the information provided in the proposal is true to the best of our knowledge. We agree to comply with the terms and conditions of IBITF's grant and actively pursue the proposed objectives.

Signature of CEO/Head of organization:
Date:
Place:

Call for Proposal Summary Table

Category	Who Can Apply	Funding contribution from the applicant	Key Deliverables	IP & Revenue Sharing	Notes
1. Startups/Industry Submitting a New Idea to IBITF	DPIIT-recognized startups, Registered companies (MSMEs or Enterprises) with prior product development or R&D experience.	40% 60:40	- Prototype/MVP within 6 - 8 months - Go-to-market readiness and business plan within 12 months	Based on IP contributions, investment, and commercialization.	Academic collaboration encouraged

Project Assessment Framework

Quarter	Assessment Focus	Reviewers
Q1	TRL Baseline, Infra Setup, Hiring	IBITF + Mentor
Q2	Prototype, Interim Validation	IBITF + Industry Partner
Q3	Pilot Deployments, TRL Advancement	External Expert + BoD Review
Q4	Commercial Readiness, Business Plan Review	BoD + External Technical Expert

SPV Execution Guidelines

- **SPV Setup:** Private Limited Company with a dedicated bank account.

- The financial processes, policy, and corporate governance of the SPV shall be shared with approved projects before the disbursement of the funds.